

PocketBudJet

Your Money. Your Device. Your Rules.

User Manual

Version 1.2 — April 2026

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Need Help?

1. Getting Started

Download and install PocketBudJet in minutes, then set up your first budget with our easy 9-step onboarding wizard.

- Download from Google Play Store (iOS coming soon)
- Complete 9-step onboarding wizard on first launch
- Set up your first budget in minutes
- Enter your gross pay and take-home pay — the wizard automatically calculates your paycheck deductions
- Choose a budget template or create a custom budget
- Want to itemize deductions later? Tap any income transaction and choose Paycheck Breakdown
- Enjoy a 35-day free trial with full app access — no credit card required

2. Dashboard Overview

Your dashboard gives you a complete snapshot of your finances at a glance. See your income, spending, and net position in real-time.

- Income, Spent, and Net overview cards
- Spending pace indicator to track against your budget
- Available-to-spend daily number to guide daily decisions
- Customizable widget layout — arrange cards to your preference
- Quick access to key actions like adding transactions
- Historical trends and comparisons
- Anomaly alerts when unusual spending is detected

3. Adding Transactions

Quickly log your spending and income. PocketBudJet makes it easy with manual entry, smart splits, and attachments.

- Manual transaction entry with just a few taps
- Split bills across multiple people or categories
- Transfer transactions between accounts
- Attach photos and notes to track receipts and details
- Smart credit card payment splitting — automatically allocate to original purchase categories
- Quick-amount presets for common purchases

4. Importing Data

Easily import your financial data from banks and other sources. PocketBudJet supports multiple file formats for maximum compatibility.

- Universal CSV import — works with most financial institutions
- OFX/QFX/QIF/XLSX format support from banks and brokers
- PDF bank statement import with intelligent parsing
- Screenshot import — snap a photo of any financial screen
- Email receipt import — forward receipts to the app
- Notification capture — automatically detect transactions from banking app notifications
- Multi-month imports for comparing spending patterns
- Duplicate detection and conflict resolution
- No bank login or credentials required

5. Scanning Documents

PocketBudJet features industry-leading document scanning. Transform paper receipts and bills into organized transactions.

- Receipt scanning with item-level OCR — extract every purchase detail
- Bill and pay stub scanning for income documentation
- WiFi network scanner (eSCL) with ADF support — scan entire multi-page bank statements from your home printer in one tap
- No competitor offers home printer scanning at this scale
- Automatic categorization of scanned items
- Handwriting recognition for handwritten notes on receipts
- Universal document scanner for any financial paperwork

6. Budget Management

Set spending limits, choose from proven budget templates, or create your own. Track your budget progress with visual overlays.

- Create categories with custom spending limits
- 5 built-in templates: 50/30/20, Zero-Based, Aggressive Saver, Envelope, and Freelancer
- Budget rollover — carry unused funds to next month
- Copy previous month's budget to save time
- Budget Health Overlay — visual progress indicators
- Annual budget view for long-term planning
- Budget variance reports — see exactly where you're over or under
- Adjust budgets mid-month as your priorities change

7. Bills & Recurring Transactions

Never miss a payment. PocketBudJet tracks bills, recurring transactions, and subscriptions with smart predictions.

- Bill calendar with payday markers for easy planning
- Recurring transactions (daily, weekly, biweekly, monthly, annual)
- Recurring income tracking with gross pay and deduction breakdowns
- Smart bill amount prediction — automatically adjusts based on history
- Subscription tracker with price-change alerts
- Cancellation links for easy subscription management
- Upcoming bills overview to reduce surprise overspending
- Recurring forecast — see your next 30 or 90 days of recurring costs

8. Savings & Goals

Track savings progress, create sinking funds, and plan purchases. Build financial security step by step.

- Savings goals with progress tracking and milestones
- Sinking funds for irregular expenses (car repairs, holidays, etc.)
- Purchase wishlist with 30-day cooling-off period to curb impulse buys
- What-if scenarios — explore different savings strategies
- Goal reminders and motivation tracking
- Visual progress bars and achievement badges

9. Debt Management

Take control of debt with avalanche and snowball strategies, credit card insights, and payoff projections.

- Track all debts in one place — credit cards, loans, mortgages
- Avalanche vs snowball strategy comparison and recommendations
- Credit card intelligence — deferred interest detection, rewards tracking
- Payoff timeline projections and scenario planning
- Interest calculation tools
- Debt consolidation insights
- What-if scenarios — see how extra payments accelerate payoff

10. Investments & Net Worth

Comprehensive investment and net worth tracking in one app. Monitor stocks, crypto, real estate, and credit score.

- Investment portfolio tracking — stocks, ETFs, mutual funds, bonds via Yahoo Finance
- Crypto tracking with 19 coins: Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, Cardano, Dogecoin, and more via CoinGecko

- Property and real estate tracking with Zillow search integration
- Credit score monitoring from 6 different sources
- Net worth tracker with monthly snapshots and trend analysis
- Asset allocation visualization
- Insurance policy tracker with renewal alerts

11. Reports & Analytics

Deep dive into your spending and financial health with 10+ powerful report types and anomaly detection.

- Budget Health Report — see where money goes vs. budget
- Financial Health Score — comprehensive wellness overview
- Projected Balance Report — forecast future cash position
- Spending Forecast Report — predict upcoming expenses
- Anomaly Dashboard — identify unusual transactions and patterns
- Year over Year Report — compare spending trends
- Tax Return Report — organize deductible expenses
- Annual Budget Report — yearly spending summary
- Net Worth History Report — track asset growth
- Merchant Analysis Report — identify spending by vendor
- Custom reports — build your own with flexible filters
- Automated spending anomaly alerts

12. AI Financial Coach

Get personalized financial insights powered by your spending data. The coach learns your habits and suggests improvements.

- Personalized insights based on aggregated data only
- Opt-in feature — you control what data is analyzed
- Spending pattern recognition and recommendations
- Budget adjustment suggestions based on trends
- Savings opportunity identification
- Financial goal progress tracking
- Weekly AI recap with spending highlights and insights

13. AI Assistant

Ask questions about your finances in plain English. The AI Assistant understands natural language and queries your data directly — no menus to navigate.

- Conversational Q&A — type questions like "How much did I spend on groceries last month?"

- Supports 11 query types: spending totals, category breakdowns, merchant lookups, income summaries, budget status, trends, comparisons, top merchants, recent transactions, net position, and custom date ranges
- Natural language date parsing — "last week", "this quarter", "January"
- Results displayed with formatted amounts, charts, and lists
- All processing happens on-device — your data never leaves your phone
- Quick-start example questions to get you going
- Available from any screen via the AI Assistant button

14. Search

Quickly find any transaction with natural language search. Ask questions like a human.

- Natural language search — type "coffee last week" to find coffee purchases
- Search by amount — "over \$50" finds large transactions
- Search by date range, category, merchant, or tags
- Fuzzy matching for misspelled merchant names
- Saved search filters for frequent queries
- Universal search across all data types

15. Export & Sharing

Share your financial data in multiple formats. Create reports for accountants or analyze data in Excel.

- Export formats: CSV, JSON, PDF, Word, Excel, OFX, HTML
- Accountant report export with tax-deductible items highlighted
- LAN report server — view on any screen via QR code on your home network
- Share specific date ranges with partners or accountants
- Encrypted exports for sensitive data
- Scheduled exports to cloud storage

16. PC Web Dashboard

Access your PocketBudJet data from any computer on your home WiFi network. Full dashboard with charts, editing, and real-time sync.

- Open your dashboard in any web browser on your home network
- Scan a QR code or type the URL — no app install needed on your PC
- 5 tabs: Dashboard overview, Transactions, Budget, Debt, and Reports
- Full CRUD — add, edit, and delete transactions, debts, goals, budgets, and sources from your browser
- Charts and visualizations: spending by category, income vs expenses, trends
- Session-based security with auto-timeout after 60 minutes of inactivity
- Real-time sync — changes on your phone appear instantly in the browser and vice versa

- Start and stop from Settings → Export → PC Dashboard

17. Tax Features

Organize tax-deductible transactions and simplify tax time. Tag expenses and generate tax reports.

- Tag transactions with 8 IRS categories for deductibility
- Tax-deductible transaction summary and category breakdown
- Tax return import and comparison to validate deductions
- Quarterly tax estimate calculator
- Mileage tracking for business use
- Self-employed income tracking

18. Household Sync

Share finances with a partner using WiFi and Bluetooth. Keep both devices in sync without the internet.

- WiFi and Bluetooth partner sync via secure QR code pairing
- No internet connection required — sync on your home network
- Real-time transaction sync between devices
- Joint budget management and visibility
- Separate or shared views of spending
- Conflict resolution for simultaneous edits

19. Calendar View

See your financial life on a calendar. Bills, income, and spending laid out by date for easy planning.

- Monthly calendar with transaction dots showing activity
- Tap any day to see that day's transactions
- Bill due dates and payday markers
- Recurring transaction indicators
- Color-coded: green for income, red for expenses
- Swipe between months for quick navigation

20. Transaction Bookmarks & Rules

Save time with reusable bookmarks for frequent transactions and automated rules for categorization.

- Bookmark frequent transactions — one tap to reuse
- Bookmarks remember description, amount, category, and source
- Usage counter tracks your most-used bookmarks
- Transaction rules — auto-categorize based on merchant name or patterns

- Rules apply to imported and manually entered transactions
- Bulk edit — change category or status for multiple transactions at once
- Labels management — rename employers, bill payees, and categories in one place

21. Accessibility

PocketBudJet is built for everyone. Multiple accessibility features ensure you can manage your money comfortably.

- Dark mode for comfortable viewing in all lighting
- High contrast mode for better readability
- Colorblind-friendly charts using Okabe-Ito color palette
- App lock with Face ID, Touch ID, or PIN protection
- Large text option for improved visibility
- Screen reader compatibility
- Font scaling support

22. Mindful Features

Enjoy a healthier relationship with money. Mindful Budget View reframes overspending, and Time Cost Mode shows hours-of-work.

- Mindful Budget View — reframes "over budget" as "fully used"
- Time Cost Mode — displays how many hours of work each purchase cost
- PBJ Stars badges — celebrate financial milestones and achievements
- Spending reflection prompts
- Financial wellness check-ins
- Motivational insights and encouragement

23. Retirement Planning

Plan for retirement with milestone tracking. PocketBudJet uses Fidelity milestone bands and FIRE basics.

- Retirement milestone tracker with Fidelity milestone bands
- FIRE (Financial Independence, Retire Early) basics tutorial
- Retirement savings goal planning
- Safe withdrawal rate calculations
- Retirement income projection
- Progress tracking toward retirement milestones

24. Voice Shortcuts

Control PocketBudJet with your voice. Use Siri (iOS) or Google Assistant to log transactions hands-free.

- 6 built-in voice shortcuts accessible via Siri or Google Assistant
- Log transactions by voice — "Hey Siri, I spent \$20 on coffee"
- Check budget status — "What's my monthly budget?"
- View current spending — "How much have I spent this month?"
- Create savings goals by voice
- Custom voice shortcuts for your most frequent actions

25. Pricing

Flexible pricing plans to match your needs. Start free with a 21-day trial — no credit card required.

- 21-day free trial — full app access, no credit card needed
- Monthly: \$9.99/month with auto-renew
- Annual: \$74.99/year (37% off monthly rate)
- 3-Year: \$149.99/three years (58% off monthly rate, no auto-renew)
- All plans include full feature access
- Cancel anytime during free trial
- Money-back guarantee within 30 days

26. Privacy & Security

Your data is yours alone. PocketBudJet uses on-device storage with no cloud requirement and no bank login needed.

- All data stays on your device — no cloud upload by default
- No bank login or credentials required
- No cloud requirement for core functionality
- Encryption for exported files
- Optional cloud backup for device loss protection
- Transparent privacy policy — no ad tracking

App Lock & Recovery Key

Protect your financial data with biometric or passcode lock. PocketBudJet generates a recovery key so you can always regain access yourself — no support request needed.

- App lock with Face ID, Touch ID, or a custom passcode
- Recovery key generated on your device when you enable a lock — shown once, store it safely
- Recovery key is stored only as a secure hash and never sent to any server

- Manage your key anytime: Settings → Security → Recovery Key (rotate or remove)
- Locked out? Enter your recovery key to reset instantly — no reinstall, data untouched
- Entire lock system works offline — fully self-contained, no account required

Need Help?

Email: support@jospatech.com

Website: jospatech.github.io/how-to

27. Data & Storage Management

Control how much history lives on your device, how long your backup keeps records, and free up space without losing a single dollar of financial history. Access via Settings → Data & Backup.

Backup Retention

- Choose how far back your backup keeps full transaction details: 6 months up to 7 years
- Data that ages out is summarized — annual totals, top categories, and net savings are locked permanently
- Summaries are yours forever regardless of which retention window you choose

On-Device Working Set

- Controls how many months of transactions live on your phone for instant offline access
- Minimum 3 months — the floor PocketBudJet needs to reliably track budget patterns
- Extend up to 2 years if you want more history available without fetching from backup

Receipt Image Storage

- Three-tier model: thumbnails always stay on device, full images live in backup, compressed previews are tiered
- Choose your preview window: 30, 60, 90, or 180 days on-device before moving to backup-only
- Tap any receipt to fetch the full image from backup whenever you need it

Annual Summaries

- Year-by-year totals computed and locked permanently before any data ages out
- Income, expenses, and net savings for every year you've used the app — never deleted
- Power your all-time analysis even after underlying transactions have been archived

Free Up Space

- Tap 'Review & Free Up Space' to preview exactly what would be removed before anything happens
- Preview shows transaction count, receipt image impact, and estimated space reclaimed
- Annual summaries are always computed and backup-confirmed before any data leaves the device

Archive History

- Track the status of every archived year: transaction count, backup confirmation, and completion date

- Years show as 'Pending' until backup confirms receipt — data stays on device until confirmed
- Full audit trail so you always know what has been safely stored

Thank you for using PocketBudJet. Your data. Your device. Your rules.